JANE DOE

MASTER BELLFOUNDER | CAMPANOLOGIST | TOWER RESTORATION CONSULTANT

I did not choose bells. My grandfather cast them, my father turned them, and by the time I was seventeen I understood that I would spend my life ~~I was seventeen~~ listening for the note hidden inside raw bronze. What follows is the record of that listening.

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FOUNDRY AND RESTORATION WORK (BY DISCIPLINE)

Bronze Casting and Metallurgy

- Cast and turned 401 church and civic bells ranging from 2 cwt to 34 cwt, 2003–present, across three employers below.
- Developed a revised copper–tin ratio for the foundry's small-bell range, reducing post-cast tuning correction by an estimated one-third.
- Personally supervised 601 individual pours over the course of my career, including 4 large civic bells cast for municipal clock towers.

Tuning and Harmonic Analysis

- Returned the 8-bell ring at a Grade I listed parish church (nominal note sequence restored to concert pitch after 140 years of drift).
- Trained 3 apprentice tuners in five-tone harmonic analysis (hum, prime, tierce, quint, nominal).
- Diagnosed and corrected a persistent "wolf" tone in a 6-bell ring that three previous tuning attempts by other foundries had failed to resolve.

Tower and Frame Engineering:

- Assessed and specified replacement headstocks and bearings for 12 towers.
- Consulted on the structural loading assessment for a Cathedral ring prior to a full rehang.
- Advised a diocesan Surveyor's office on 5 separate tower stability assessments following unrelated roof restoration work that had raised concerns about bell-frame loading.

Historical and Archival Research

- Catalogued foundry marks and inscriptions on 60+ historic bells for a regional diocesan archive.
- Contributing researcher, Church Bells of the Eastern Counties (privately published survey, 2015)
- Identified and correctly attributed a previously unmarked 17th-Century bell to a historic Whitechapel area foundry lineage, based on alloy composition and inscription style, a finding accepted by the diocesan

EMPLOYMENT

Senior Founder and Tuner, Ashcombe Bell Foundry, London Uk, 2011 to date.

Lead founder for the firm's restoration division, personally overseeing the largest and most historically sensitive commissions. Manage a team of 3 founders and 2 apprentice tuners

Founder, Meredith & Sons Bellfoundry, Loughborough, Uk, 2003 to 2011 (foundry acquired by Ashcombe in 2011; role and duties continued without interruption under new ownership)

Ran the foundry's day-to-day casting operations under the family ownership prior to acquisition, working directly under the firm's then-owner, a fourth-generation founder.

Apprentice Founder, Meredith & Sons Bellfoundry, Loughborough, Uk, 1999 to 2003.
Completed the traditional multi-year foundry apprenticeship, rotating through moulding, casting, fettling, and early tuning instruction.

Foundry Yard Assistant (informal, family arrangement) my grandfather's small casting workshop, a village outside Loughborough, weekends and school holidays, 1991–1999.
My grandfather ran a much smaller casting operation than either employer listed above, largely repair and small agricultural bell work, and I spent most weekends from age eleven sweeping the yard, mixing loam for moulds, and eventually being allowed to help pour small bells under close supervision. This is not formal employment and predates my apprenticeship by nearly a decade, but it is, in every way that matters, where this career actually began.

EDUCATION

Formal - Degrees

- B.Eng. Materials Science, University of Sheffield, 1999

Formal - Certifications

- City & Guilds, Advanced Foundry Practice, 2001

Informal - Guild Training

- Full liveryman, Worshipful Company of Founders, admitted 2014.

SELECTED RESTORATION PROJECTS.

Full 8-bell rehang and retune, a Grade I listed parish church, Southeast England, Completed 2017, referenced above Tuning and Harmonic Analysis.

Structural assessment and partial rehang; a Cathedral ring, referenced above, Consulting role only, 2019–2020.

Casting of 2 replacement bells for a municipal clock tower following wartime damage, Completed as part of a heritage restoration grant project, 2013.

Diocesan archive cataloguing project, 60+ bells surveyed across 14 individual towers, 2015–2015.

PUBLICATION AND PRESS

Contributing researcher, Church Bells of the Eastern Countries (privately published survey, 2015) profiled in a regional heritage crafts newsletter, "The Last Few Who Still Pour Bronze by Ear," 2021. Occasional Contributor, the Central Council of Church Bell Ringers' quarterly newsletter, technical notes column, 2018 to present.

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Worshipful Company of Founders, Craft Excellence Commendation, 2016 (a guild honor, not a competition placement). Heritage Crafts Association, shortlisted for a Red List of Endangered Crafts advocacy award, 2020 (shortlist only, not a win, listed for completeness given the field's genuine scarcity of practitioners).

AFFILIATIONS

Central Council of Church Bell Ringers, Technical Advisory panel, 2016 to present. Full liveryman, Worshipful Company of Founders, admitted 2014.

REFERENCES

Available on request through Ashcombe Bell Foundry's Office. Several referees are diocesan surveyors bound by their own institutional contact protocols.